ATELIER TECHNIQUE REFERENCE

SEWING TIPS

& Master Construction Methods

A comprehensive visual reference guide to fine garment construction, seam finishing, dart manipulation, edge grading, waistline facings, and full lining insertion.

Margot Elastic Wide-Leg Pants Collection · Tailoring Reference

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Personal Tailoring Notes & Pattern Modification Log included on Page 11

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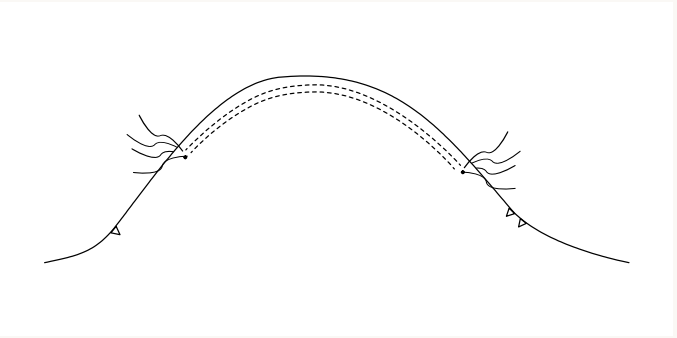
Authentic Vector Construction Systems · Tailornova Patternfast Standard · High-Definition Print

SEAMS

Some images show pins along seamlines. Sewing over pins when assembling a garment is not recommended.

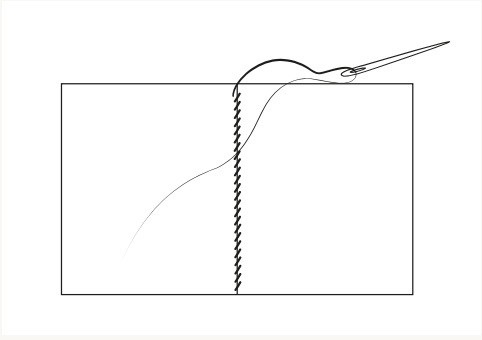
EASESTITCH

Stitch along seamline, using long machine stitches. Pull thread ends when adjusting to fit.
NOTE: For sleeve caps, make a second row of long machine stitches 1/4" (6mm) away in seam allowance for more control.



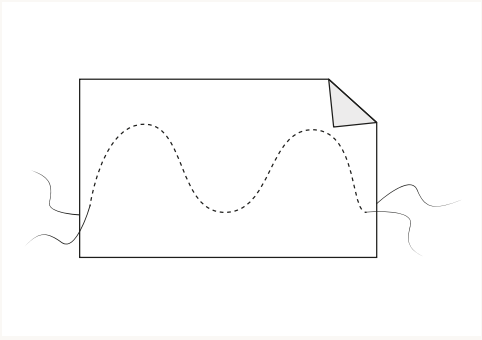
SLIPSTITCH

Slide needle through a folded edge, then pick up a thread of underneath fabric.



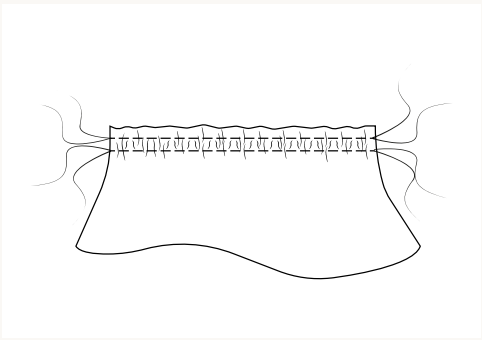
TOPSTITCH

On outside, stitch 1/4" (6mm) from edge, seam or previous stitching (or where indicated in instructions), using presser foot as guide.



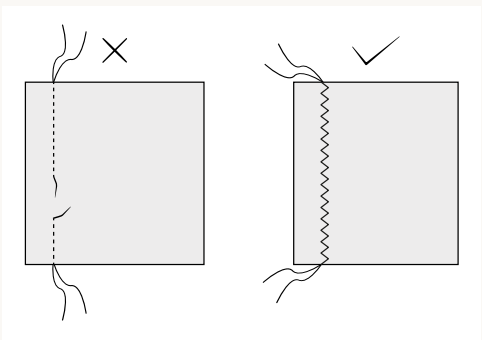
GATHER

Stitch along seamline and again 1/4" (6mm) away in seam allowance, using long machine stitches. Pull thread ends when adjusting to fit.



SEAM FINISHING FOR KNIT GARMENTS

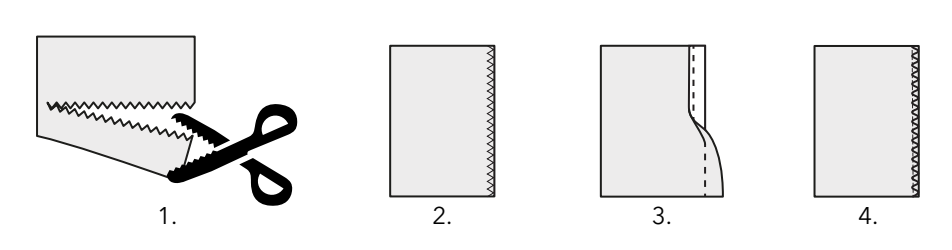
A regular straight stitch will usually not work well for sewing seams with knits. It may sew nicely, but the seam will easily pop and break when stretched. A simple zigzag stitch will allow the seam to stretch without popping.



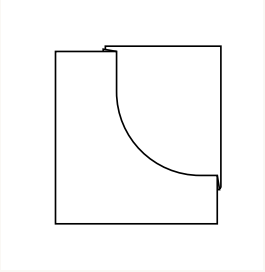
SEAM FINISHING

To give a more finished look to the inside of the garment, finish raw edges using one of the following methods:

1. Trim the edge using pinking shears.
2. Stitch a zigzag stitch along the edge.
3. Stitch 1/4" (6mm) from raw edge and turn in along stitching. Then stitch close to the fold.
4. Using a serger sewing machine, stitch along the edges without trimming away any fabric.

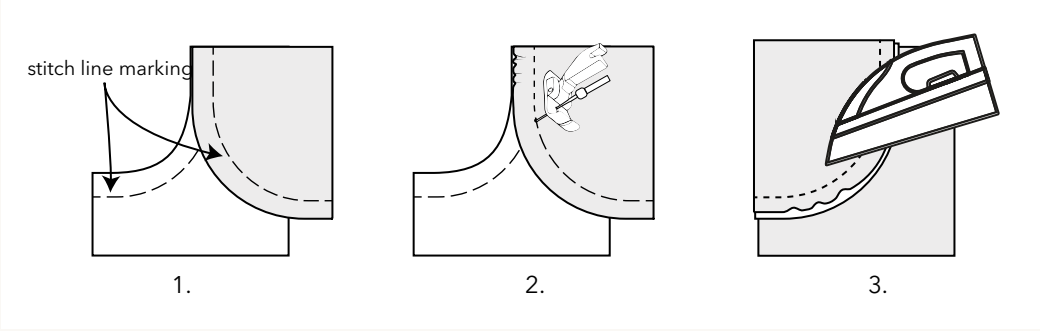


CURVED SEAM



Curved seams are quite commonly used when sewing together a garment. In many cases the curved seam is the **style line** of the garment, such as princess seams, bodice yokes or skirt yokes.

1. Mark stitch lines and place concave and convex curved pieces on the sewing table with right sides together.
2. Start stitching same as for plain seam to point where stitch line (or edges of fabric) begin to diverge. Turn needle down into fabric and raise presser foot. Pivot upper fabric around needle until stitch lines (or fabric edges) converge. Continue stitching.
3. Press entire seam to one side.



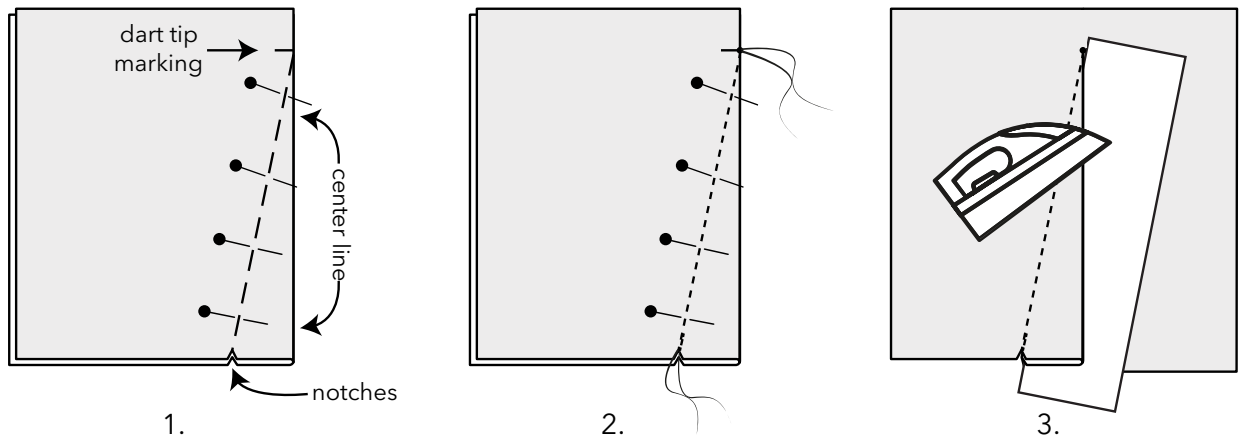
DARTS

STRAIGHT TAPERED DART

Transfer dart markings from the pattern to the wrong side of the fabric. Notch the ends of the dart lines and mark the dart tip.

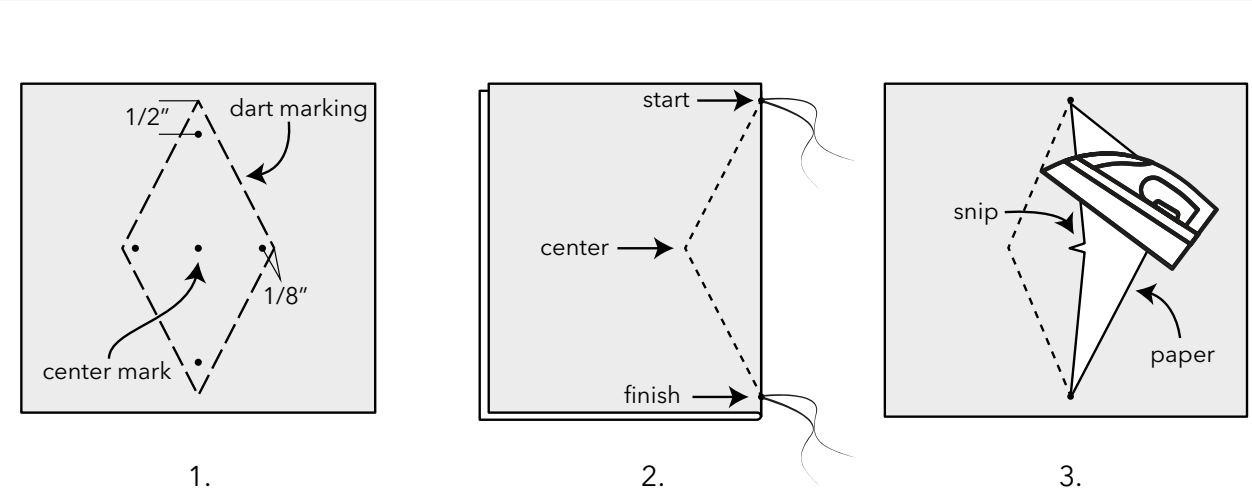
1. With right sides together, fold dart so that the notches match. Fold dart along center line to the dart tip marking. If necessary, pin and pencil in the stitch line.
2. Start from the top of the dart. Backstitch at the beginning, leaving a long thread tail at the dart tip. Knot the thread tails at the dart tip. Make sure the needle enters the fabric exactly on the fold at the stitch line for a couple of stitches.
3. Press dart excess toward center or down. Press from the wrong side only.

NOTE: When pressing, place a strip of paper between the dart and the fabric to prevent an impression from appearing on the right side of the garment.



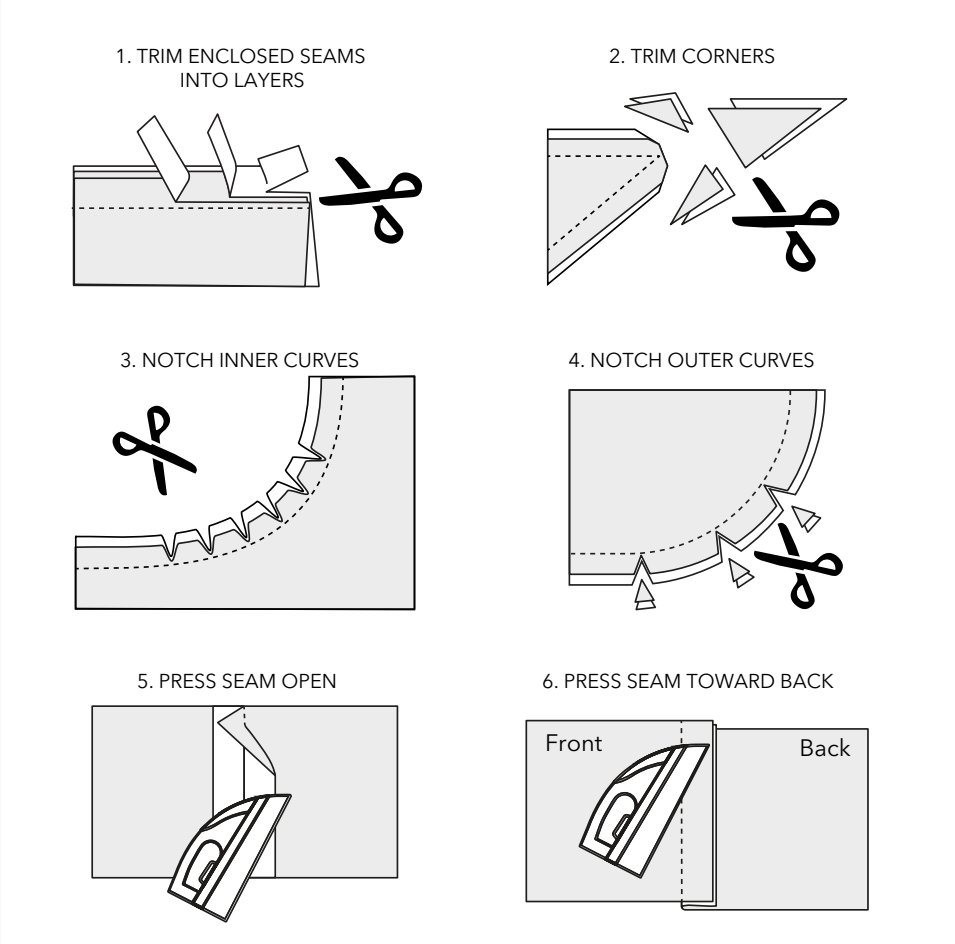
DOUBLE FISHEYE DARTS

Double darts are used at the waistline of a cut-in-one garment such as a dress, vest, or jacket.
1. Transfer dart markings from the pattern to the wrong side of the fabric. Place a pin through the pattern and both layers of the fabric 1/2" from each end of the dart and mark with pencil. Also mark at center of dart and 1/8" in from the widest point of the dart.
2. With right sides of the fabric together, fold the crease of the dart so that the top, bottom and center marks are in one continuous fold. Start to sew from the top to the center, then to the bottom (following the marking).
3. Press the dart with the wrong side of the fabric up. Snip the fold at the center of the dart if needed. Press finished dart toward center of the garment.
HINT: *When pressing, place a strip of paper between the dart and the fabric to prevent an impression from appearing on the right side of the garment.*



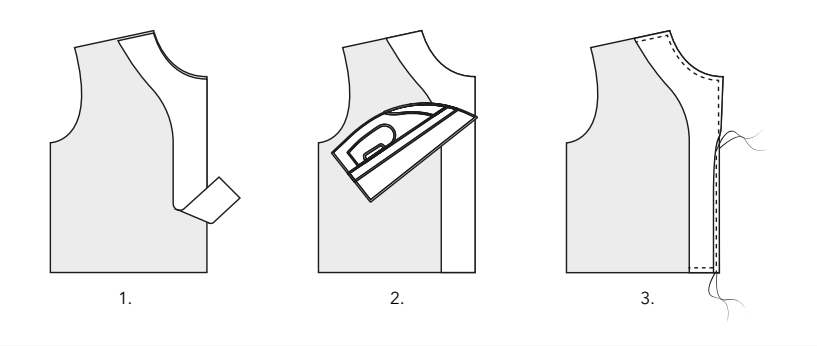
TRIMMING AND CLIPPING SEAMS

You can sew a lovely neat seam and press it perfectly, but if you don't trim and grade those seams where necessary, you will be left with a bulky, bumpy appearance on the right side of the garment. Trimming refers to reducing a seam allowance to prevent bulk. Grading is used in an enclosed seam to reduce the bulk created by the layered seam allowances. Trim, grade and press in the right places and your seams will look as smooth as silk.



INTERFACINGS

Interfacing is a layer of fabric that is cut in the same shape as the facing piece and placed between the garment and the facing pieces. Interfacings are used to give support and body to garment areas such as collars, cuffs, lapels, pockets, necklines, yokes, waistbands, and button and buttonhole areas.
Fusible interfacing has heat-sensitive adhesive on one side that is ironed onto the fabric.
Select interfacing based on fabric type (knit or woven) and required weight for facing piece.
Press-on interfacing is applied by the process of bonding. A quick method of attaching the interfacing includes the following steps:
1. Cut the interfacing to the desired shape and size. Place the coated side of the interfacing piece to the wrong side of the garment area to be interfaced.
2. Using a steam iron, press the interfacing to the fabric, by lifting the iron and steaming a section at a time. If the interfacing does not adhere to the fabric, use more steam and more iron pressure.
NOTE: Clean-finish the outer edge of the facing pieces if desired. A small hemming stitch may be used, or you may overlock or zigzag stitch the outer edge with your sewing machine (Pic. 3).



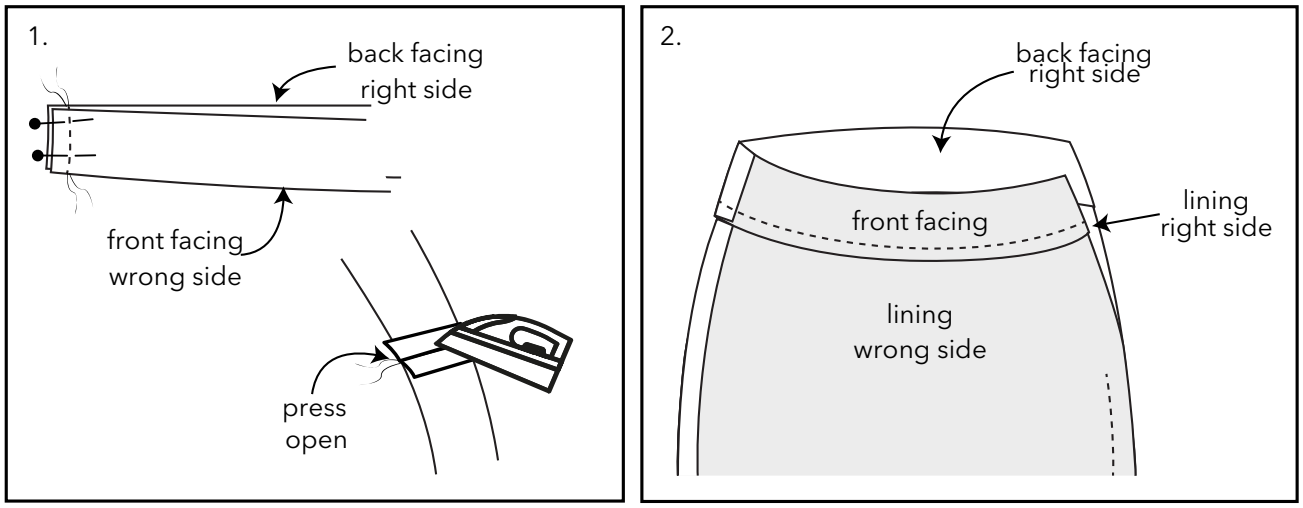
LINING

- Lining will make a garment made from itchy fabric (like wool) more tolerable on your skin. Lining will also hide unsightly seams like on the inside of a jacket or on light-colored fabric. They provide additional warmth and give a garment structure, shape and a better fit. Most importantly, linings hide the underbelly of your garment: the inner raw edges, seams and darts.
- The lining is sewn separately along with the outer garment. It is then joined together with hand sewn stitches or machine stitches along the neckline and/or armhole or side seams and along the zipper/opening (or waistband for skirts).

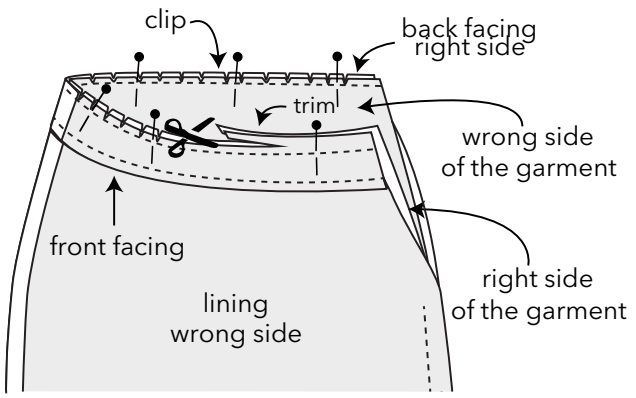
EXAMPLE: Skirt (with facing)

1. Apply fusible interfacing to the wrong side of facings, following manufacturer's instructions. With right sides together, pin Front and Back Facings at side seams, then stitch. Press seams open.
2. Sew the main skirt following instructions, then repeat all steps for lining. Attach lining to facing.
3. With right sides together, pin facing to waist edge of the garment, matching notches, centers and seams, then stitch.
4. Trim facing's seam allowance to 1/8" (3 mm) and waist seam allowance to 1/4" (6 mm). Clip into the curves.
5. Press seams toward the facing. Understitch facing, then turn to inside and press.
6. Tack at side seams from inside.

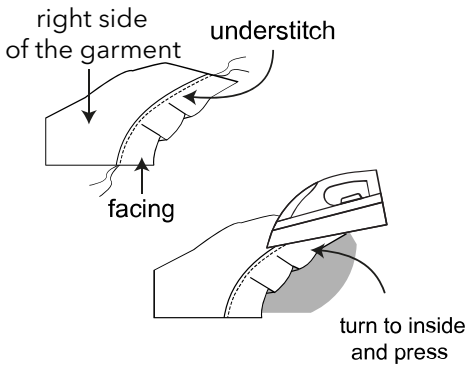
NOTE: If there is a closure facing, slipstitch facing and lining to closure facing nearest edge.



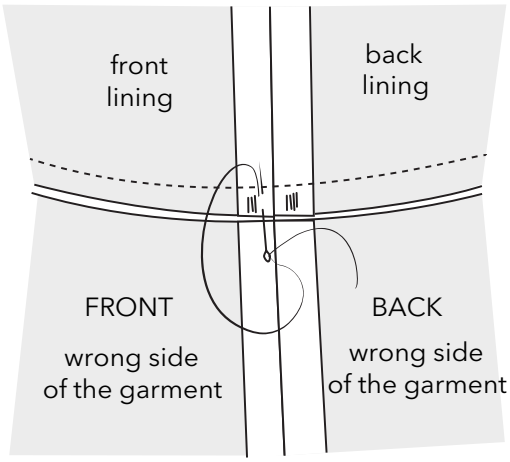
3.


clip
back facing
right side
trim
wrong side
of the garment
front facing
right side
of the garment
lining
wrong side

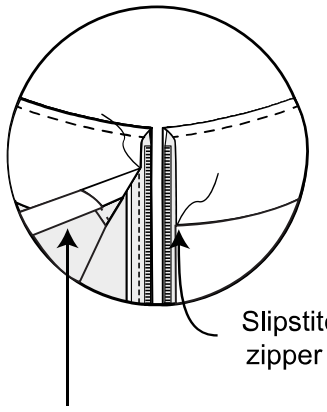
4.


right side
of the garment
understitch
facing
turn to inside
and press

4.


front
lining
back
lining
FRONT
wrong side
of the garment
BACK
wrong side
of the garment

6.


Slipstitch to
zipper tape
turn facing to inside,
turning in ends to clear zipper teeth

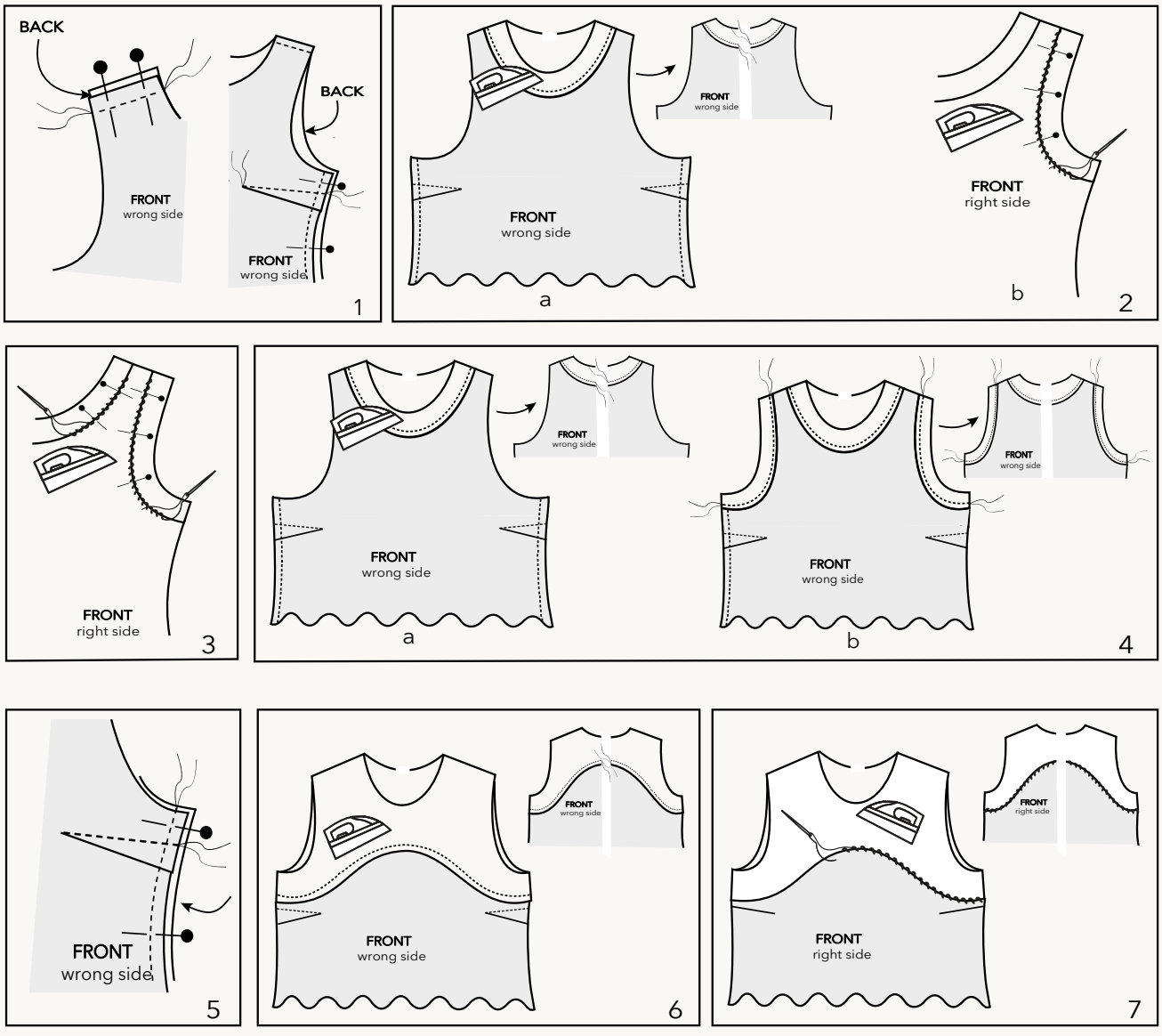
LINING TO THE NECK FACING

Sewing the lining to the facing of the neck and armholes

- Sew the shoulder and side sections lining of the back and front (Pic. 1).
- Join the shoulder seams of the lining with the shoulder seams of the neck facing. Pin and sew. Turn out, press (Pic. 2a).
- Sew the lining to the armhole facing with a hidden seam in a circle, folding the seam allowances. Press (Pic. 2b).
- Connect and pin the neck of the lining to the facing of the neck by joining the shoulder seams. Sew with a hidden seam.
- Connect and pin the armholes of the lining to the armhole facings by joining the shoulder and side seams. Sew with a hidden seam around the circle. Press (Pic. 3).
- Join the shoulder seams of the lining with the shoulder seams of the neck lining. Pin and sew. Turn out, press (Pic. 4a). Pin from the inside of the armhole of the lining and the facing of the armhole from the side seam to the shoulder. Sew, then repeat this operation from the side of the back. Turn out, press (Pic. 4b).

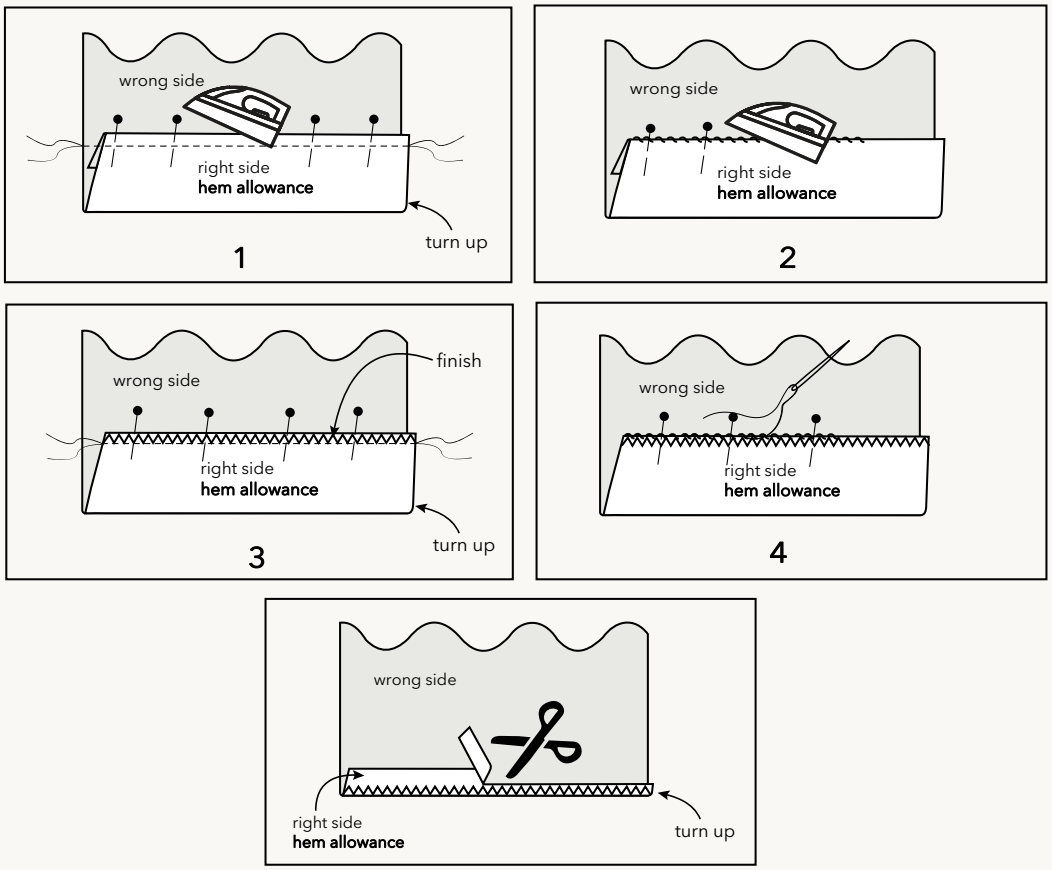
Sewing the lining to the one piece facing of the neck and armhole

- Sew the side pieces lining of the front and the back (Pic. 5).
- Join the side seams with the facing of the neck and armhole. Pin and sew in a circle. Turn out, press. (Pic. 6).
- Bend the allowances of the lining and pin it to the one piece facing. Sew it with a hidden seam (Pic. 7).



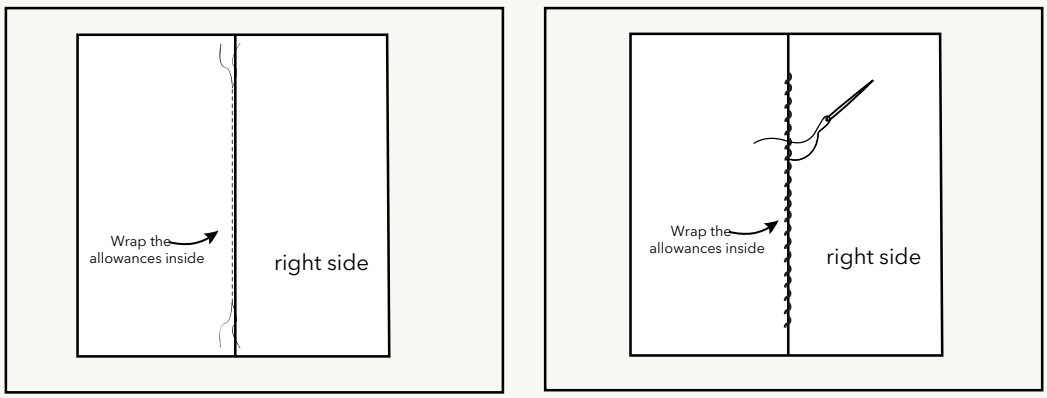
HEMMING A LINING

- Turn the hem up along the fold line twice, then iron. Sew the hem in place (Pic. 1) or use a hidden seam (Pic. 2).
- Turn the hem up along fold line. Sew hem in place (Pic. 3) or use a blind hem stitch (Pic. 4). Press.
- Turn the hem up along the fold line and stitch close to the fold line. Cut the rest of the fabric (Pic. 5). Press



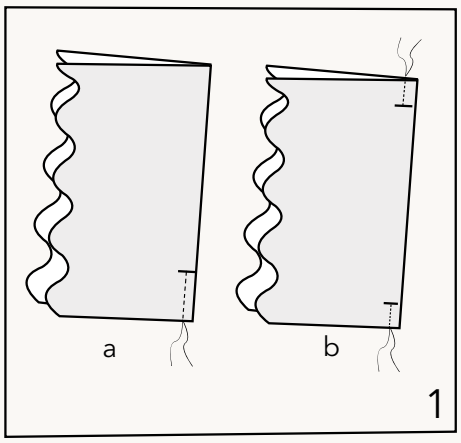
TURNING THE GARMENT OUT

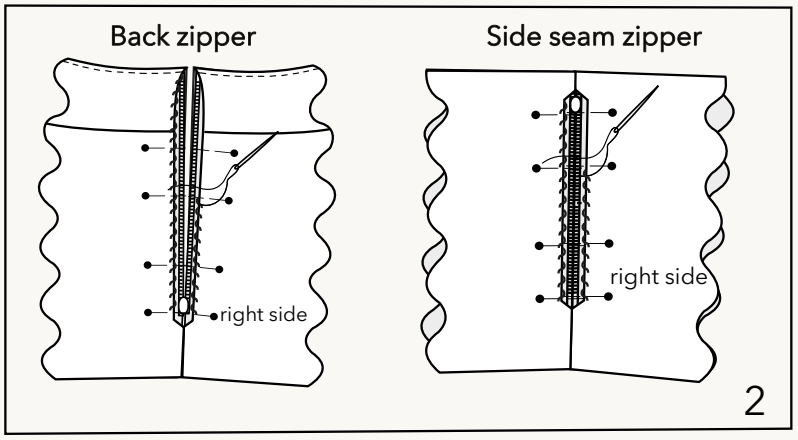
- Turn back and pin the lining hem to the garment hem at the inseam, making sure the within area is not twisted.
- Pull the garment through the lining opening, then pin and sew the hems together with right sides together.
- Wrap the allowances inside and stitch as close as possible to the edge (Pic. 1).
- Sew with a hidden seam (Pic. 2).

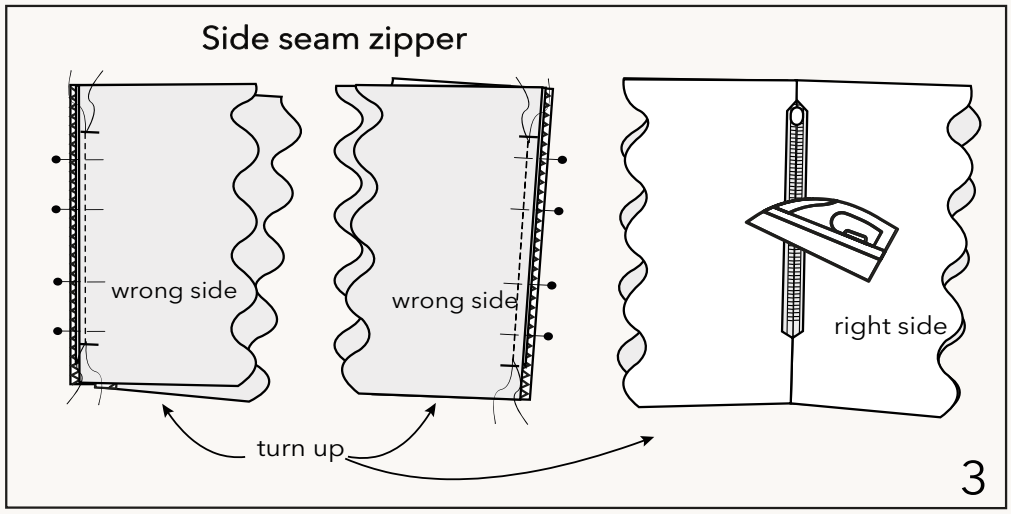


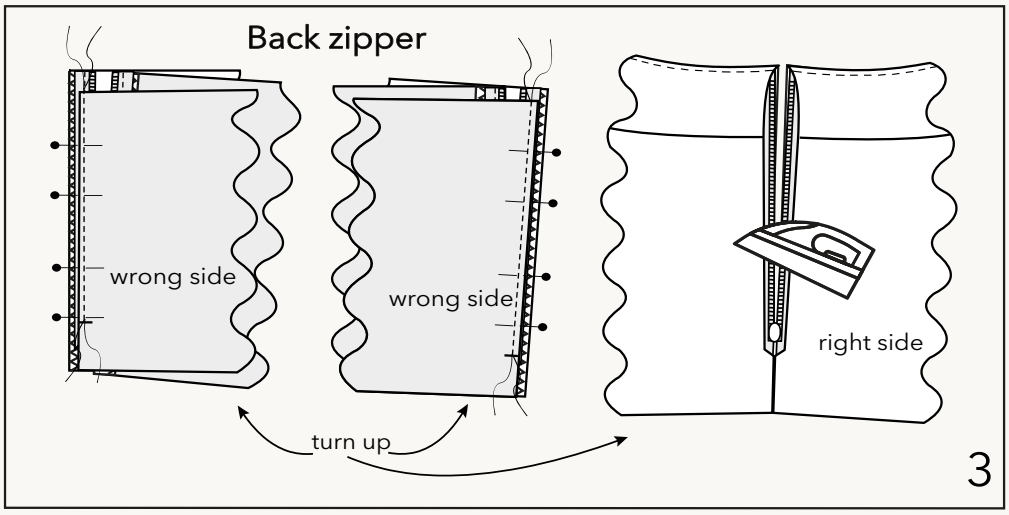
SEWING LINING TO THE ZIPPER

- Open the fastener already sewn to the fabric of the top. Sew the lining along the seam of the back (Pic. 1a) or the side seam (Pic. 1b), leaving the necessary part free for sewing the fastener.
- Bend the allowances of the lining, then pin and sew with a hidden stitch (Pic. 2)
- Place the edge of the lining facing inwards to the edge of the fastener (without teeth). Pin it and sew down the center of the allowance until the foot meets the seam on the lining. Repeat on the other side, turn and iron (Pic. 3).









PERSONAL TAILORING NOTES & PROJECT LOG

Record your measurements, fabric behavior, needle choices, and custom fit adjustments.

Garment / Pattern: Margot Elastic Wide-Leg Pants **Pattern Size Cut:** _____

Date Started: _____ **Date Finished:** _____ **Graded Sizes:** _____

Fabric Description: _____

Needle Type / Size: _____ **Thread Used:** _____

CONSTRUCTION OBSERVATIONS & CUSTOM FIT MODIFICATIONS